



has middle-range margins, while the lowest margins are typically in ULIPs. Depending on customer needs, we aim for a balanced product mix.

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Why has the industry started focussing on ULIPs?

You have to see it in context. I've been in the industry for 17 years, and during times when markets rise quickly, you typically see a higher mix of ULIPs. It's just a matter of adjusting to market conditions.

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What product mix do you aim to have in FY25?

We are close to our ideal mix. Typically, a 60:40 mix (of traditional and ULIP) is good for us, but within that, we aim for 15-20% par, close to 35% non-par, around 15% for annuities and protection combined, and the balance through ULIPs. Currently, we have about 10% from protection.

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How do you see synergies with Axis Bank increasing with the higher stake?

The synergies are

substantial. Our Chairman, Rajiv Anand, is the Deputy MD of Axis Bank, and we have four top team members from Axis Bank on our board.

It is our largest distributor, contributing 52% to our sales. This deep collaboration helps us strategically in growth, product mix, and new channels.

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Do you see a risk in having 52% of your business coming from one partner?

It used to be higher. We are intentionally reducing this

dependence by signing up with more partners. This strategic move reduces risk and ensures a more balanced distribution.

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Max Life is listed as Max Financial Services. Do you aim to list it directly?

Max Financial Services is the holding company of Max Life, with no operating business/assets of its own, except its shareholding in Max Life. To simplify our structure, we aim to be directly listed and are working towards merging Max Financial Services with Max Life, subject to regulatory approvals.

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What are your views on Irdai's stance on surrender charges?

The industry aligns with Irdai's efforts to benefit customers. We believe the decision will create a win-win for both customers and the industry.

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What are your views on composite licences?

Composite licences, which allow life insurers to offer health insurance, can significantly expand our reach and opportunities.

This integration can leverage our vast distribution network to improve health insurance penetration. Enabling this integration can significantly expand our reach and sales opportunities. This time it's not in the hands of Irdai. This will be by government as law. **BT**

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